



EXTERNAL HARD DRIVES

Portable Hard Drives

Seagate 100 GB ST9100801U2-RK

Specs: 100 GB, 5400 rpm Spindle Speed, 8 MB Data Buffer, USB 2.0 (no FireWire), Power Over USB Interface, Blue-LED Visual Indicator

Our Verdict: An external portable hard drive with a large data buffer size of 8 MB and high spindle speed of 5400 rpm is without doubt an exceptional product. The USB interface also supplies the power needed to

run the drive. The drive's splendid speed in our data transfer tests is a noteworthy mention.



Runner-Up: Western Digital Passport 40 GB

Desktop External Hard Drives

Maxtor 300GB One Touch II

Specs: 300 GB, 7200 rpm Spindle Speed, 16 MB Data Buffer, USB 2.0 and FireWire, powered externally by adapter, power button single press initiates backup.

Our Verdict: External desktop drives are targeted as backup solutions. The Maxtor One Touch II with 300 GB of storage space had everything going for it. It performs like a dream, thanks in good part to the large

data buffer. The drive can be connected via USB or FireWire, and also includes backup utilities. Maxtor has also priced this product affordably.



Runner-Up: Seagate 400GB Barracuda

INPUT DEVICES

Logitech G7 Laser Cordless Mouse

Specs: 2000 dpi Laser Engine, 6 buttons, USB dongle, 2.4 GHz Wireless, Sensitivity Switching Buttons, Battery Level Indicators, 2 Lithium Ion batteries.

Our Verdict: The Logitech G7 laser cordless gaming mouse delivers extreme gaming performance and control with its 2000 dpi high precision laser engine. The bi-directional USB connection sends a blazing 500 reports/seconds over 2.4 GHz wireless. The twin "hot swappable" Li-ion battery packs help reduce "downtime".

The Setpoint software that accompanies the mouse augments the G7's performance

and features by adding programmability to the various buttons and adding the option to access sensitivity levels other than the three presets available in hardware. Even without drivers, the sensitivity switching buttons offer the option of changing the mouse sensitivity in-game allowing you to quickly adapt to various situations at the press of a button. This one gets a well deserved Zero One award.



Runner-Up: Logitech MX-1000

BUSINESS NOTEBOOKS

Workhorse Notebooks

MSI MegaBook M510C

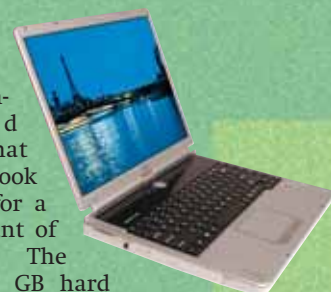
Specs: Pentium M 1.5 GHz, 256 MB RAM, ATi Mobility Radeon 9700, 15.4-inch LCD, 80 GB Hard Drive, Combo Drive, 802.11g, Gigabit LAN

Our Verdict: The MSI MegaBook M510C has an ergonomic keyboard and touchpad, which are desirable in a Workhorse laptop. The 15.4-inch LCD has a native resolution of 1400 x 1050, the highest in its category. This, along with the large viewing angles it provides, makes it easy to work on without straining the eyes.

The fast processor and the ATi Mobility

Radeon 9700 on-board ensure that this notebook is ready for a fair amount of gaming. The ample 80 GB hard drive was the highest-capacity drive in this category. Battery life is a decent two hours.

Overall, this is a good buy, especially considering the moderate price tag.



Runner-Up: ACI Emerald C2